

Pollinator Habitat — Staff & Client Guide

This guide is for Conner Prairie staff who run Pollinator Habitat events and review survey data. It covers how the game works, how to set up and run an event, how to use the admin portal, and how to interpret the data.

No technical background is required to use this guide.

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1. What Is Pollinator Habitat?

Pollinator Habitat is a **self-guided nature walk game** for park visitors. Players use their own smartphone (no app download needed — just a web browser) to:

- Walk a physical route through the park
- Stop at marked locations to read interpretive content
- Learn a fun fact about a pollinator at each stop
- Discover which pollinator is associated with their route at the end

The experience is designed for families and groups of all ages. Multiple visitors can play simultaneously, each getting their own route assignment.

How players join: Visitors scan a QR code posted at the park entrance or activity area. The QR code takes them directly into the day's session — no typing, no account creation, no app download required.



QR code for the main game — scan

to open Pollinator Habitat at <http://10.200.0.5/>

Data collected: After completing their first route, players are asked how many adults and children are in their group. This survey is optional and anonymous — no names or contact information are collected.

2. The Routes

There are **11 pollinator routes** in the system. Each route covers a different set of stops around the park and features a different pollinator. Players are assigned routes automatically — they do not choose.

Route	Stops
Human	5
Bat	6
Hummingbird	5
Sunbird	5
Moth	6
Butterfly	6
Fly	6
Bee	7
Wasp	7
Beetle	5

Players who complete all 11 routes and finish every available stop see a completion screen. Players who complete a route can start a new one — the system automatically assigns them one they haven't done yet.

3. Running an Event — Step by Step

Before the event

1. Get the QR code for today's session.

Each event day has a unique session code (a 9-digit number) pre-generated by the system. Your IT team will provide a printed QR code — or a digital image of one — for each event day. The QR code encodes a direct link to the game that automatically joins that day's session.

If you need a QR code for a date not already prepared, contact your IT team. See [QR Code Setup](#) for how they are generated.

2. Post the QR code where visitors will see it.

Place the QR code at the park entrance, activity area, or wherever visitors start their visit. Common placements:

- A printed sign or foam board at the activity check-in point
- A laminated card handed to visitors on arrival
- A banner or kiosk near the route start

Visitors scan the code with their phone's camera (iPhone and Android both recognize QR codes natively — no app needed). The game opens instantly in their browser.

During the event

- Visitors play at their own pace — no facilitation needed once they're in
- Multiple visitors can play simultaneously with no conflicts
- Players keep their progress if they close and reopen the browser on the same device — their route continues where they left off
- Players can check their discovered pollinators any time from the home screen

After the event

- Wait a few minutes after the event ends for any last survey responses to be submitted
- Use the [Admin Portal](#) to look up party size data for the session

QR Code Setup

QR codes are generated by your IT team before the event season. Each code links to a URL in the format:

```
http://[site-address]?sessionId=[9-digit-code]
```

For example, the QR code for April 15, 2026 would encode:

```
http://[site-address]?sessionId=202604150
```

When a visitor scans the code, the game loads with the session already validated — they go straight to the home screen without typing anything.

Requesting a new QR code: If you need a code for a date outside the pre-prepared range, or need a replacement, contact IT with the event date. They can generate the session in the system and produce a new QR code within minutes.

4. What Players Experience

Step 1 — Scan the QR code

Players point their phone camera at the QR code posted at the park. The phone recognizes the code automatically and offers to open the link — players tap to confirm. The game loads in their browser and they land directly on the home screen, already connected to the day's session.

No typing, no account, no app download.

If a player cannot scan the QR code (older phone, camera issue, etc.), they can manually open the game URL in their browser and type the 9-digit session code on the entry screen. Ask your IT team for the URL and today's session code to have on hand as a fallback.

Step 2 — Home screen

The home screen shows:

- A button to **Start Route** (begin or resume their current route)
- A button to view their **Pollinator Collection** (pollinators they have discovered)
- A button for **Accessibility Settings**
- A count of how many pollinators they have discovered out of the total (e.g. "3 / 11")

Step 3 — Walking the route

After tapping **Start Route**, players see a map-style screen showing their current stop. They walk to the marked location and tap through the interpretive cards:

- **Stop card** — tells them where they are on the route
- **Fact cards** — one or more facts about pollinators at this location
- A **Next Stop** button moves them forward

At the final stop, the route's pollinator is revealed with an illustration and a summary fact.

Step 4 — Party size survey (first route only)

After completing their first route, a short survey appears asking:

- How many adults are in your group? (tap +/-)
- How many children are in your group? (tap +/-)

Tapping **Continue** submits the response and moves to the next screen. Tapping **Skip** skips the survey entirely. The survey only appears once per visit — not on subsequent routes.

Step 5 — Start a new route

After completing a route, a **Start New Route** button appears. Players tap it to be assigned the next route they haven't completed yet. The home screen's pollinator counter updates as they complete routes.

Accessibility options

Players can enable accessibility features from the **Accessibility Settings** screen on the home page:

- **Text-to-Speech** — the app reads each card aloud automatically when navigating to a new stop or fact
 - **High Contrast Mode** — increases visual contrast for improved readability
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5. Using the Admin Portal

The admin portal is available at:

```
http://10.200.0.5:3001
```



QR code for the admin portal — scan to open at <http://10.200.0.5:3001> The portal has no login — anyone who can reach the URL can access it.

Portal layout

The portal has two search options side by side:

Left side — Search by Date or Date Range

- Enter a start date to see data from a single day
- Check the "Date Range" checkbox and enter an end date to see data across multiple days

Right side — Search by Session ID Number

- Enter a 9-digit session ID to see data for that specific session

Searching by session ID

1. Type the 9-digit session code in the "9 Digit Session ID" field (e.g. `202604150`)
2. Click **Search**
3. Results appear in the table below

If you have typed anything in the session ID field, that search takes priority — the date fields are ignored even if they are filled in. To switch to a date search, clear the session ID field.

Searching by date

1. Enter a date in the **Start Date** field (format: YYYY-MM-DD, e.g. 2026-04-15)
2. For a single day search, leave the "Date Range" checkbox unchecked and click **Search**
3. For a range, check "Date Range", enter an end date, and click **Search**

Clearing results

- **Clear search** — resets all the input fields
- **Clear table** — removes the results from the table (inputs remain)

These two buttons are independent. You can clear the table without clearing your search inputs, and vice versa.

6. Understanding the Portal Results

Search results appear in a table with five columns:

Column	What it means
Session ID	The 9-digit session code
Date	The date the session was created
Adults	Total number of adults reported in party size surveys
Children	Total number of children reported in party size surveys
Total	Adults + Children

Session ID search results

When searching by session ID, the table shows **one row** with totals aggregated across all players who submitted the survey during that session.

Example: If 3 groups submitted surveys reporting (2 adults, 1 child), (4 adults, 0 children), and (1 adult, 3 children), the table shows: Adults = 7, Children = 4, Total = 11.

Date range search results

When searching by date or date range, the table shows **one row per session** that had survey responses in the date window.

When counts show "--"

-- means no data was collected for that field. This happens when:

- No players submitted the party size survey during that session
- The session exists but no one played

Important notes on the data

- **Survey responses are optional.** Not all players complete the survey. The numbers represent only players who chose to respond.

- **Multiple routes, one survey.** Each player submits the survey at most once — after completing their first route. Subsequent routes do not re-trigger the survey.
 - **Counts reflect self-reported data.** There is no way for the system to verify the accuracy of what players enter.
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7. Frequently Asked Questions

Q: A visitor says the QR code isn't working.

A: Check these common issues:

- **Camera not recognizing the code** — the code may be too small, damaged, or in low light. Try moving closer, improving lighting, or presenting a backup digital image of the code.
- **Link opens but shows an error** — the session code embedded in the QR code may be invalid or not yet in the system. Contact your IT team with the event date to verify the session exists.
- **Visitor can't scan at all** — direct them to open the game URL manually in their browser and type today's 9-digit session code. Ask IT to provide the fallback URL and code before each event.

Q: A visitor wants to join manually without scanning the QR code.

A: They can open the game URL directly in their browser. They will see a field to enter the 9-digit session code. Ask your IT team for today's session code to have available as a fallback for visitors who cannot scan.

Q: A visitor wants to continue on a different device.

A: The player's progress is tied to their device. If they switch devices, they start fresh — their previous route assignment and collected pollinators do not transfer. There is currently no account/login system.

Q: Can multiple people on the same device play?

A: They can use the same device, but the system assigns one route per device. Both players would share the same route progress and pollinator collection. For separate experiences, each person should use their own device.

Q: A visitor completed all their routes. What do they see?

A: After completing all 11 routes, the app shows a completion screen. There is no more content to play through — visitors who want to continue can restart from the home screen, but they will begin repeating routes they have already seen.

Q: The portal shows "--" for Adults and Children for our session.

A: This means no players submitted the party size survey. Either no one played, or all players tapped Skip on the survey. The routes and pollinator discoveries are not surfaced in the portal — only party size data appears there.

Q: Can we see how many people completed routes, not just party size?

A: Not in the current portal view. Route completion statistics (total routes completed, users who started vs. finished, etc.) are planned for a future update. Contact your development team for the timeline.

Q: The portal search returns no results for a date I know had visitors.

A: This can happen if:

1. The session ID for that date is outside the pre-seeded range (check with IT)
 2. Players connected but no one submitted the party size survey
 3. The date format entered is wrong (must be YYYY-MM-DD)
 4. The start date and end date are reversed (start must be before end)
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Q: Can we change what routes or facts are shown to players?

A: Route and fact content is configured in the database and cannot be changed through the portal. Content changes require a developer to update the database seed data. Contact your development team.

Q: Is player data stored indefinitely?

A: Yes, unless the database is manually cleared by IT staff. Session data, route completion records, and survey responses are retained unless explicitly deleted. If your organization has data retention requirements, discuss a deletion schedule with your IT team.

For technical issues, contact your IT administrator. For questions about event planning and content, contact Conner Prairie staff.